gesis
Leibniz Institute for the Social Sciences

Journal Data Policies

Reflections from political science and sociology academic publishing

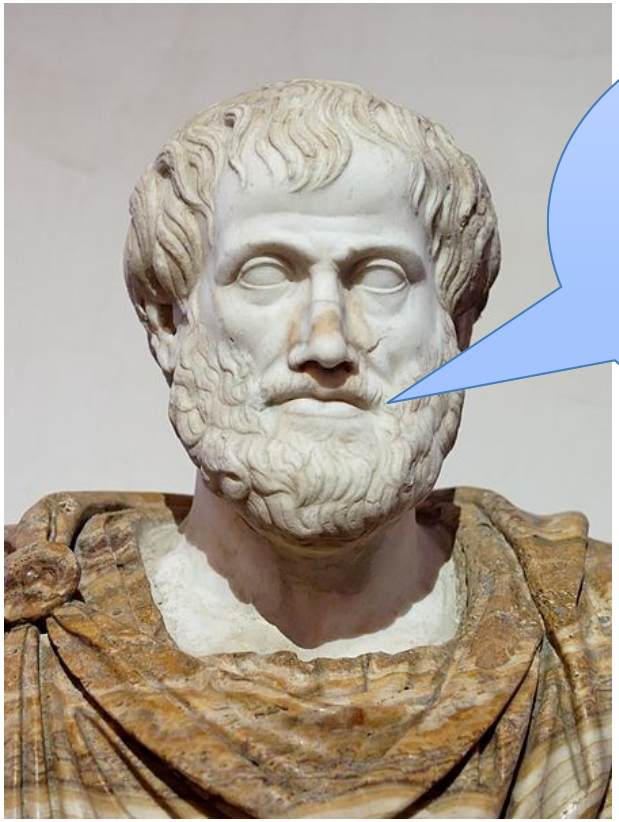
Alexia Katsanidou

IASSIST 06.06.2014

Toronto, Canada

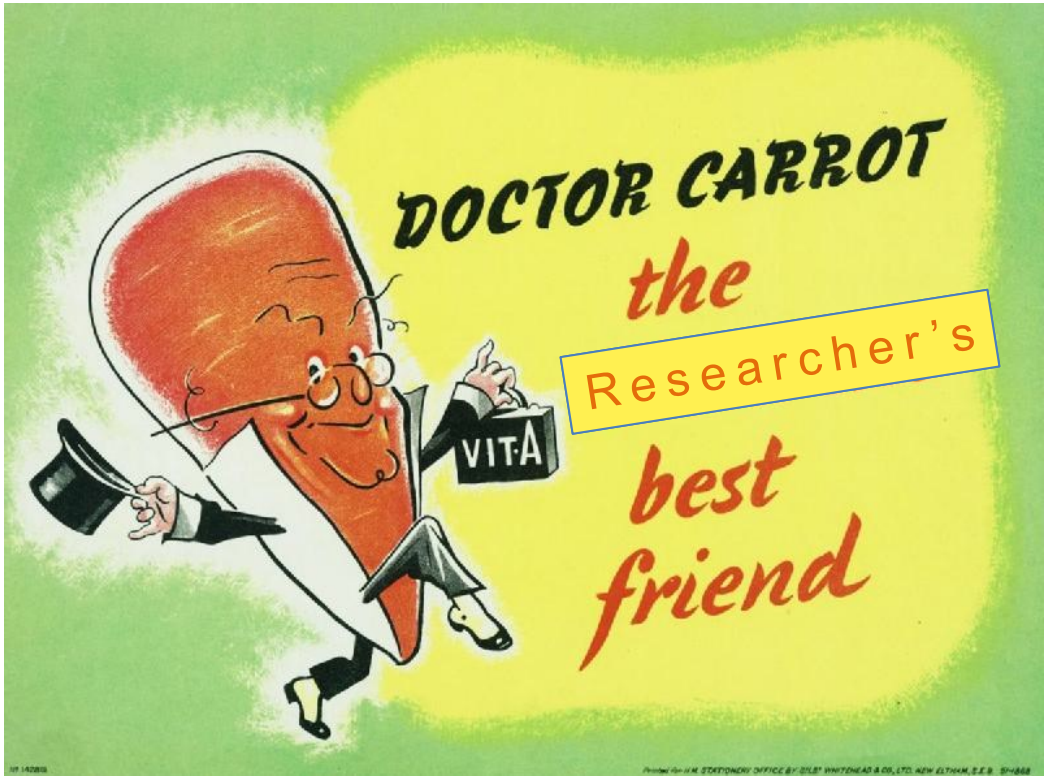
Member of the Leibniz Association

Promoting reuse: cognition vs. emotion



"Educating the mind without educating the heart is no education at all"

Why journals?



Researchers care about publications

Evaluations are based on peer review journal publications

Image licensed under IWM Non-Commercial Licence http://www.iwm.org.uk/collections/item/object/29038

Why journals?

- Data sharing is key for replication and re-use in empirical research.

- Scientific journals can play a central role by establishing data policies and providing technologies.

Evidence

- Gherghina, S., & Katsanidou, A. (2013). Data Availability in Political Science Journals. *European Political Science*.

- Zenk-Möltgen, W., & Lepthien, G (2014) Data sharing in journals from sociology. *Unpublished working paper*

1. investigating journal data policies
2. author behavior

3. Political Science and Sociology

Political Science

Table 1: The data policies situation reflected on the websites and editor letters

Policy status	Website policies	Answers by 1 December	Answers after 1 December
In place	18	1	0
Prospective policy (including discussions)	n/a	4	3
No policy	57	13	6
No plans to adopt a policy	n/a	14	4

Table 3: Correlations between the existence of data policies and journal characteristics

Correlation with ...	Coefficient	Number of cases
Age of the journal	0.20**	120
Frequency	0.02	120
Language	0.17*	120
Type of audience	−0.29***	120
Impact factor	0.49***	95

***, **, * is statistically significant at 0.01, 0.05 and 0.1 respectively.
Note: Correlation coefficients are either Pearson or Spearman, depending on the type of variables.

Sociology

Lanuage	English	Other	Bi-lingual		Sum
Count	122 (87.1%)	14 (10.0%)	4 (2.9%)		140
Number of issues	1-3	4	5-12		Sum
Count	19 (13.6%)	86 (61.4%)	35 (25%)		140
Age of journal	6-22	23-36	37-51	52-118	Sum
Count	36 (25.9%)	34 (24.5%)	35 (25.2%)	34 (24.5%)	139
Data policy	Explicit	Common	None		Sum
Count	7 (5%)	94 (67.1%)	39 (27.9%)		140

Table 1: Attributes of sociology journals

Journal characteristic	Data policy: yes	Data policy: yes or should	No. of cases
Impact factor	0.204*	0.384**	135
English language	0.088	0.618**	140
Issues per year	0.005	0.268**	140
Age of journal	-0.045	-0.031	139

Table 2:Correlations between existence of data policies and journal type (Spearman rho, * indicates significance level of 0.05, ** indicates significance level of 0.01)

Policy Compliance

Journal	Impact factor (5-year)	Language English	Issues per year	Age in years	Data Policy
ASR	5.563	Yes	6	77	Yes
AJS	5.239	Yes	6	118	No
SM	2.662	Yes	1	42	Yes
ZfS	0.724	No	6	41	No
KZfSS	0.602	No	4	92	No

Table 3: Characteristics of selected journals in sociology

Journal	Articles	Empirical	Data available	Availability proven	Own data & available
AJS	328	55 (16.8%)	19 (34.5%)	5 (9.1%)	1 (1.8%)
ASR	89	81 (91.0%)	61 (75.3%)	25 (30.9%)	5 (6.2%)
SM	38	9 (23.7%)	1 (11.1%)	1 (11.1%)	-
ZfS	59	38 (64.4%)	12 (31.6%)	1 (2.6%)	1 (2.6%)
KZfSS	67	39 (58.2%)	22 (56.4%)	3 (7.7%)	-
Sum	581	222 (38.2%)	115 (51.8%)	35 (15.8%)	7 (3.2%)

Table 4: Characteristics of articles published in selected journals (percent base for rate of empirical articles are all articles, for other columns the percent base is the number of empirical articles only)

Journal characteristic	Data available	Availability proven	Own data & available
Impact factor	0.244**	0.284**	0.126
English language	0.112	0.211**	0.077
Issues per year	0.056	0.105	0,094
Age of journal	-0,032	-0.044	-0,053
Data policy	0,282**	0.297**	0,114

Table 5: Correlations between articles mentioning data availability and journal characteristic (Spearman rho, ** indicates significance level of 0.01, N=222 empirical articles)

Conclusion

- Data Policy matters, but it has to be properly implemented
- Authors are happier to comply when the carrot is juicier

Thank you for your attention!